



# VEGETABLES AND FRUITS WITH MEDICINAL VALUES A REVIEW

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**Abstract:** Vegetables are well-known for being good for your health. Most vegetables are good source of high in vitamins, minerals and fiber. However, some vegetables stand out from the rest with additional proven health benefits, such as the ability to fight inflammation or reduce the risk of disease. The vegetables contain several phytochemicals possessing antioxidant activity. The major groups of phytochemicals include vitamin A, C, E and K, carotenoid, terpenoid, flavonoids, polyphenols, saponins, enzymes and minerals. These nutrients are vital for overall health and maintenance of body systems. Eating a diet high in fruits and vegetables can reduce a person's risk of developing heart disease, cancer, inflammation, and diabetes. Citrus fruits and berries may be especially powerful for preventing disease

**Keywords:** Vegetables, vitamins, flavonoids, saponins, Citrus fruits.

## Introduction

Green leafy vegetables (GLVs) play an important role in human nutrition. Vegetables are well-known for being good for your health. Most vegetables are good source of high in vitamins, minerals and fiber. However, some vegetables stand out from the rest with additional proven health benefits, such as the ability to fight inflammation or reduce the risk of disease (Link R. 2017). Fruits and vegetables are universally promoted as healthy. Fruits and vegetables supply dietary fiber, and fiber intake is linked to lower incidence of cardiovascular disease and obesity. Fruits and vegetables also supply vitamins and minerals to the diet and are sources of phytochemicals that function as antioxidants, phytoestrogens, and anti-inflammatory agents and through other protective mechanisms. Most countries have dietary recommendations that include fruits and vegetables (Joanne L 2012 Jul). Eating a diet high in fruits and vegetables can reduce a person's risk of developing heart disease, cancer, inflammation, and diabetes. Citrus fruits and berries may be especially powerful for preventing disease (Butler N. 2019). Vegetables prevents human from several sever and chronic diseases. The vegetables contain several phytochemicals possessing antioxidant activity. The major groups of phytochemicals include vitamin A, C, E and K, carotenoid, terpenoid, flavonoids, polyphenols, saponins, enzymes and minerals. These nutrients are vital for overall health and maintenance of body systems (Nahak G. 2014).

**Potassium:** Many fresh fruits and vegetables are rich in potassium: Bananas, oranges, cantaloupe, honeydew, apricots and grapefruit (Robinson J. 2020).

**Fiber:** the vegetables and fruits have great sources of fiber, which can cut your LDL ("bad") cholesterol, is good for your digestion, and helps you, feel full. Fruits are Apples, bananas, oranges, strawberries (Dersarkissian C. 2022).

**Folate (folic acid):** The body uses folate to form healthy red blood cells. Women of childbearing age who may become pregnant and those in the first trimester of pregnancy need adequate folate to reduce the risk of neural tube defects such as spina bifida during fetal development.

**Vitamin A, E and C:** These vitamins are found predominantly in green and yellow vegetables. Together, they protect against infection, help maintain eye and skin health, aid in wound healing, and have antioxidant functions ([www.healthyeating.org](http://www.healthyeating.org))

## Vegetables and fruits with medicinal values

### Papaya



The papaya is a small, sparsely branched tree, usually with a single stem growing from 5 to 10 m (16 to 33 ft.) tall, with spirally arranged leaves confined to the top of the trunk (Heywood VH 200)

Papayas contain high levels of antioxidants vitamin A, vitamin C, and vitamin E. Diets high in antioxidants may reduce the risk of heart disease. The antioxidants prevent the oxidation of cholesterol. When cholesterol oxidizes, it's more likely to create blockages that lead to heart disease (www.webmd.com)

### Medicinal uses of papaya

- Reduce the risk of heart disease.
- High-fiber diets lower cholesterol levels.
- Papaya has folic acid, which is essential for converting the amino acid homocysteine into less harmful amino acids. Papaya leaves have been used as a treatment for malaria, (Titanji, V.P 2008)
- Used as an abortifacient, a purgative, or smoked to relieve asthma.
- Help to prevent cancer
- Protect vision (Cervoni B. 2021)

### Cosmetics used

- Reduces wrinkles
  - Control acne
  - Remove dead skin cells
  - Soothes irritated skin
- Improve skin tone (Hamdani S. 2020)

### Marketed products of papaya

#### AL – Ayurvedic Life Papaya 120 Tablets

Ayurvedic Life's Papaya is considered to be a natural source of vitamin C and vitamin A, hence a natural source of antioxidants that may help in improving immunity and aids in weight management.

#### Renew Papaya Fruity Skin Whitening Soap

The Renew Papaya Fruity skin whitening Soap has whitening as well as antioxidant properties. The beauty soap will make the skin brighter and clear (www.imbms.com)

#### Zandu Papaya Leaf Extract Tablet

Zandu Papaya Leaf Extract Tablet is made from the natural goodness of Papaya fruit extracts. Apart from improving the blood platelets counts, It has a gamut of health benefits being a natural source of vitamins C and E. (<https://zanducare.com>)

**Khadi Essentials Papaya & Ferment Beans Ayurvedic Serum Sheet Mask – 20 ml**

Bring fruit to your face with the Khadi Essentials papaya and ferment bean oil control sheet mask. Papaya provides 3-layer deep skin nourishment, intense hydration and a lasting glow. Its active ingredients help increase skin elasticity, balance and control oil production and help bring out fresh dewy skin. Ferment bean is an active Korean ingredient that helps provide clear and blemish-free skin (<https://www.tatacliq.com>).

**Himalayan Organics Papaya Anti Blemish & Pigmentation Removal, Spot Removal, Brightening & Fairness Cream – 50ml (<https://www.thehimalayanorganics.in>)****Papaya Leaf Juice | Papita patta Swaras**

Effectively increases blood platelet production, ability to fight viral infection, supports digestion, removes intestinal worms ([www.raykart.in](http://www.raykart.in))

**Spinach**

Spinach (*Spinacia oleracea* L.), an annual plant, is a green, leafy vegetable that can be grown in both spring and autumn (M. Antonia Murcia 2020). Spinach is a vegetable. The leaves are used for food and to make medicine. Spinach beet is a popular leaf vegetable of the Indian subcontinent. Leaves and petioles are cooked for preparing stews. Kale is steamed and served with butter or vinegar, or in soups (Roy S. 2003).

**As a medicine, spinach is used**

- Treat stomach and intestinal (gastrointestinal, GI) complaints and fatigue.
- It is also used as a blood-builder
- an appetite stimulant ([www.rxlist.com](http://www.rxlist.com))
- For Lowering blood pressure,
- Asthma prevention, Cancer prevention and Bone health (Olsen N. 2018)

There are numerous health benefits associated with the consumption of spinach and these are attributed to its lipid-lowering properties and cardiovascular protection, antiobesity effects, hypoglycemic activity, anti-inflammatory effects, anticancer properties, neuronal protection, antimacular degeneration, among others (PANDEY S. 1993).

**Cosmetic uses**

- Prevents Sun Damage to the Skin
- Help to improve skin texture and treat a number of skin related disorders.
- prevents premature ageing ([www.lybrate.com](http://www.lybrate.com))

## Broccoli



Broccoli (*Brassica oleracea* var. *italica*) is an edible green plant in the cabbage family (family Brassicaceae, genus *Brassica*) whose large flowering head, stalk and small associated leaves are eaten as a vegetable. Broccoli is a rich source of vitamins, minerals, and antioxidants. Antioxidants can help prevent the development of various conditions (Booth S. 2021)

- Vegetables may inhibit the development of cancer in several organs, including the bladder, breasts, liver, and stomach.
- These compounds may protect cells from DNA damage,
- inactivate cancer-causing agents,
- anti-inflammatory effects (Hodgson L. 2020 )

### Cosmetic uses

- Promotes Hair Growth
- Nourishes Skin
- Treats Acne
- Makes Hair Shiny (<https://beautymunsta.com>)

## Beets



Beetroot comes from the same family as sugar beets. However, it is genetically and nutritionally different. Sugar beets are white, and manufacturers tend to use them for extracting sugar and sweetening processed foods.

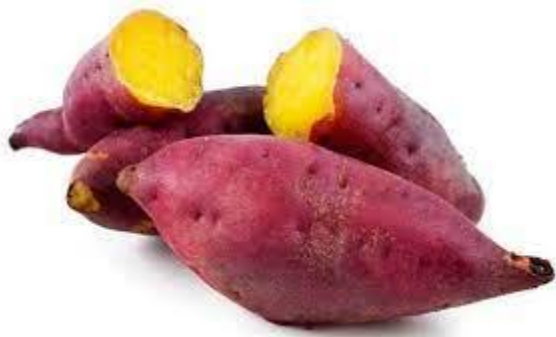
Beetroot provides a wide range of possible health benefits,

- such as reducing blood pressure
- improving digestion,
- Lowering the risk of diabetes ( Warwick K. 2019)
- Fight inflammation throughout the body and Eating beetroot maintains healthy potassium levels
- Potassium deficiency – when we're not consuming enough – can cause fatigue, digestive issues and weakness ([www.pushdoctor.co.uk](http://www.pushdoctor.co.uk))

### Cosmetic use

- Anti-aging
- Beets For Acne And Pimple
- Beets For Your Health
- Bright Lips
- Hydrates Dry Skin
- Blemishes, Dark Spots and Dark Circles
- Smooth Silky Skin
- Prevents Wrinkles
- Skin Pigmentation (Arivalan K.2021)

### Sweet potatoes



Sweet potatoes are sweet, starchy root vegetables that are grown worldwide. They come in a variety of sizes and colors including orange, white, and purple and are rich in vitamins, minerals, antioxidants, and fiber (Julson E. 2019)

- Just one sweet potato gives you 400% of the vitamin A you need each day.
- This helps keep your eyes healthy as well as your immune system
- Sweet potato defense against germs
- It's also good for your reproductive system and organs like your heart and kidneys (DerSarkissian C. 2021)

### Cosmetic uses

- Reduces Oily Skin
- Improve Skin Texture
- Skin Rejuvenation And Anti-Aging
- Hair Growth
- Skin Moisturizing (Vaughn A.)

### Mango





*Mangifera indica*, commonly used herb in Ayurvedic medicine. *Mangifera indica* (MI), also known as mango, aam, it has been an important herb in the Ayurvedic and indigenous medical systems for over 4000 year. Mangoes are sweet, creamy fruits that have a range of possible health benefits. They are highly popular around the world (Meeks S. 2022)

Various parts of plant are used as a dentrifice, antiseptic, astringent, diaphoretic, stomachic, vermifuge, tonic, laxative and diuretic and to treat diarrhea, dysentery, anaemia, asthma, bronchitis, cough, hypertension, insomnia, rheumatism, toothache, leucorrhoea, haemorrhage and piles (Shah K. 2010).

### Marketed preparation

Immun Mango Special, Is a Unique Formulation of Micronutrients with Amino Acid, Growth-Supporting Co-Factors and Bio Stimulant

## Lemon



The lemon (*Citrus limon*) is a species of small evergreen trees in the flowering plant family Rutaceae, native to Asia, primarily Northeast India (Assam), Northern Myanmar or China (Morton J. 1987). The lemon is a round, vibrant fruit from the flowering plant family Rutaceae. Its scientific name is *Citrus limon*, and it's native to North-Eastern India. Cancer-fighting benefits, Prevents kidney stones, Aids in digestion and Promotes weight loss etc (Nazario B. 2020). Lemons are an excellent source of vitamin C, providing over half (30.7mg) of your daily recommended intake. There are also minimal amounts of thiamin, vitamin B6, and folate in lemon. Lemons are not a good source of minerals, but they do contain small amounts of calcium, iron, and potassium (Cervoni B. 2021).

### Some Marketed products of lemon

#### Mlesna Tea Bags - Lemon, 50 Ba g x 2 g Each 100 gm

Lemon is packed with anti-oxidants that relieve the senses and revitalize your body (www.bigbasket.com)

#### Lemon Oil

It is good to improve your concentration; Lemon oil is the most appropriate choice for you.

#### The Body Care Lemon Honey Face Pack (100 G)

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